

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1395

By Barrett

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Jim Bates upon his retirement as Hickman County Mayor.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their careers in public service; and

WHEREAS, Jim Bates is one such estimable individual, who, after serving with distinction as Hickman County Mayor since 2022, is taking a well-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Bates began his career in public service as a firefighter and paramedic, dedicating thirty years to Ocala Fire Rescue in Florida before retiring from that profession in 2017; and

WHEREAS, after relocating to Tennessee, he continued his commitment to public safety with the Dickson County Fire Department and later with Hickman County Emergency Medical Services, where he rose to the position of Assistant Director; and

WHEREAS, Jim Bates continued to serve his community in various capacities, including work within the Hickman County School System and Southwest Airlines, before entering public office; and

WHEREAS, in 2022, he was elected Hickman County Mayor and has since served with diligence and integrity in that role; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure as county mayor, Mayor Bates has led and supported numerous initiatives to improve the quality of life for Hickman County residents, including efforts to protect the Duck River, the consolidation of county offices to improve efficiency and reduce costs, and the development of a new county animal shelter; and

WHEREAS, Jim Bates has also worked to strengthen cooperation between municipal and county governments, fostering a spirit of collaboration for the benefit of all citizens; and

WHEREAS, actively involved in his community, Mayor Bates has contributed his time and talents to youth athletics programs and civic organizations; and

WHEREAS, Jim Bates is most appreciative of the love and support he shares with his wife, Tonya; children, David, Andrew, and Montana; and granddaughter, Rowyn James Clark; and

WHEREAS, throughout his distinguished career, Mayor Bates has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unqualified respect and admiration of his colleagues and the citizens he has served; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we extend to Hickman County Mayor Jim Bates our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.